THE SUSPECT BOARD — WHO IS THE PHANTOM?

Flip this over when the first pair reaches the Grand Gate. Players may read it.

SUSPECT 1 · ANTON, THE APPRENTICE

- **Writing hand:** Left
- **Daily work:** Potions (his sleeves are always singed)
- **Boots:** Short, small boots
- **Hair:** Stained purple
- **Smells of:** Sulfur

SUSPECT 2 · MASTER TOBIAS, THE CLOCKMAKER

- **Writing hand:** Right
- **Daily work:** Clocks and gears
- **Boots:** Short, small boots
- **Hair:** Snow-white
- **Smells of:** Machine oil

SUSPECT 3 · GRISELA, THE GROUNDSKEEPER

- **Writing hand:** Left
- **Daily work:** Gardens and graves
- **Boots:** Huge, giant boots
- **Hair:** Iron-grey
- **Smells of:** Compost

HOW TO SOLVE IT

Lay each **Evidence Card** you won beside the board. Every card describes **one thing about the Phantom**. Only one suspect matches **all five**.

When the Phantom hides behind the wolf door, say that suspect's name!

SPARE EVIDENCE CARDS (IF ONE GOES MISSING)

E1 · THE BORROWED BOOK (LIBRARY)

Tucked behind Barov's plinth: *Spooky Mechanisms for Beginners*, long overdue. The borrower's signature is smeared from right to left, the way a **left-handed** writer drags their hand through wet ink.

E2 · THE SINGED SLEEVE (LAB)

Under the workbench: a torn lab-coat sleeve peppered with tiny burn holes from splashed quicksilver. Whoever wore it **mixed potions every day**.

E3 · THE OILY FOOTPRINTS (OBSERVATORY)

Gear-oil footprints lead behind the great clock: **small** boots, barely bigger than a kid's.

E4 · THE MIMIC'S SNACK (MENAGERIE)

Stuck between the mimic's needle teeth: a tuft of hair stained bright **purple**.

E5 · THE STINKY GLOVE (ARMORY)

The pups drag up a glove along with the crest. It reeks of rotten eggs: **sulfur**.

MINION CARDS (DM / HELPERS: ONE CLUSTER EACH)

MINION RULE (READ FIRST)

- **Any hit destroys a minion.** No HP tracking.
- **Area powers** pop every minion they cover.
- **Bruisers** take 2 hits (12 HP).
- **Nobody goes down:** under 10 HP, minions steal hats and tie shoelaces instead of doing damage.
- **Each round:** every player acts once, then the minions act.

GEAR GREMLIN • VIAL IMP • MINI-MIMIC

AC 10 · 1 hit · Attack +3, 2 damage

- Gear Gremlin: clanks, giggles, steals a gear.
- Vial Imp: spits acid, pops in purple bubbles.
- Mini-Mimic: a tiny treasure chest with teeth.

DANCING DAGGER

AC 11 · 1 hit · Attack +3, 2 damage Pokes, twirls, clatters to the floor when hit.

CLOCKWORK BRUTE (BRUISER)

AC 12 · 12 HP (about 2 hits) · Slam +4, 1d6+2 Arrives in Wave 2. Ticks loudly. Great for Net Trap, Sandstorm Shuffle or a Look Into My Eyes! dance.

MIMIC WARDROBE (BRUISER)

AC 12 · 12 HP (about 2 hits) · Bite +4, 1d6+2 On a hit, the target is stuck inside until a friend uses an action to pull them out.

WAVE PLAN

- **Round 1:** about one minion per player (mixed types).
- **Round 2:** both Bruisers + 4–6 minions.
- **Round 3:** mop up, then the Phantom flees.
- **Wrong accusation later:** 3 more minions, 1 round.

CASE CLOSED CERTIFICATES (CUT 4 PER PAGE; PRINT 3 PAGES FOR 12)

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

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